

BULLETIN

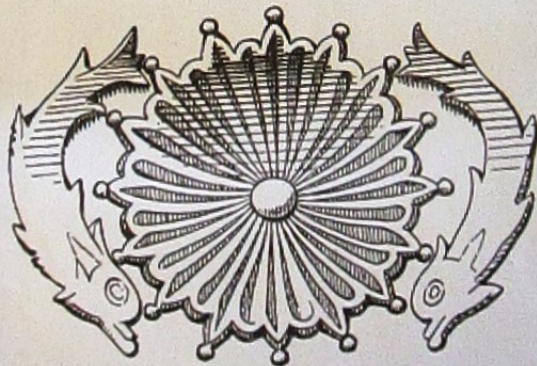
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DOXOLOGIES IN THE COPTIC CHURCH

BY

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UNEDITED ṢAʿĪDIC DOXOLOGIES.

Volumes XIII and XIV of the *Pierpont Morgan Collection*
of Coptic MSS. ⁽¹⁾.

These two volumes contain odes, hymns, theotokia, doxologies and *turūḥat*, some of which are found in the important work known as *الإبصارودية السنوية المقدسة* “*al-Abṣalmūdiyat as-Sanawiyat al-Muqad-dasah*” ⁽²⁾. The hymns in this edition are in the Bohairic dialect and are still in use in the Coptic Church.

Volume XIII of the *Morgan Collection* is entitled ΠΧΩΜΕ ΝΗΓΕΡ-ΜΗΝΙΑ ΕΤΟΥΛΛΒ “The Book of the Holy Interpretations”.

Volume XIV is entitled ΠΧΩΜΕ ΝΑΝ†ΦΑΝΟΝ ΕΤΟΥΛΛΒ ΝΗΓ-ΜΑΡΤΥΡΟC ΜΝΗΓΕΖΟΥ ΝΩΑ ΝΗΓΕΤΟΥΛΛΒ ΑΝCΖΑΙ CΟΥ ΝCΑΝΕΥ-ΕΡΗΥ ΚΑΤΑ ΘΕ ΝΤΑΝΕCΑΖ ΝΤΕΚΚΛΗCΙΑ ΚΑΛΥ ΕΖΡΑΙ. “The Holy Antiphonary Book for Martyrs and the Feast Days of the Saints which we have written out in their order, according to what the Doctors of the Church have set forth”.

The term ΑΝ†ΦΑΝΟΝ comes from the Greek ἀντίφωνον, from ἀντί “opposite” and φώνον “sounding”, and means “sounding in response”. Strictly speaking, an antiphon should be sung by two choirs, one of

⁽¹⁾ I wish to express my indebtedness to the Society of Coptic Archaeology for obtaining the necessary permission for me to edit extracts from these MSS.

⁽²⁾ Edited by C. LABIN (Cairo, 1908) and MĪNĀ AL-BARĀMŪSĪ (Alexandria, 1908).

some of the Doxologies were certainly in use by the IXth century, since these appear (in Saïdic) in Vol. XIV of the *Pierpont Morgan Collection*, a MS. which is dated $\kappa\alpha\tau\alpha\ \chi\rho\omicron\upsilon\tilde{\nu}\ \mu\alpha\rho^{\circ}\ \bar{\kappa}\bar{\theta}$ (A. M. 609 = A. D. 892-893). These Saïdic Doxologies are edited with a translation in the present article. They are found also in Bohairic, and this Bohairic version seems to have been made from a Saïdic text, at any rate, as far as the Doxologies which we have edited are concerned. For example, in the Doxology for Easter (cf. p. 183) the Bohairic rendering of $\lambda\gamma\kappa\omicron\varsigma\epsilon$, 'they prepared Him for burial', for the Saïdic $\lambda\gamma\kappa\omicron\upsilon\tilde{\nu}\epsilon$, 'they pierced Him', is probably due to the fact that the Bohairic translator read $\lambda\gamma\kappa\omicron\upsilon\tilde{\nu}\epsilon$. The context of this passage does not, however, support the reading $\lambda\gamma\kappa\omicron\upsilon\tilde{\nu}\epsilon$, 'they prepared Him for burial', since it deals entirely with what the enemies of Christ did to Him. Many of the Bohairic Doxologies were certainly composed at a much later date, e.g. the Doxology Adam for Anbā Barsūm the naked (أنبا برسوم العريان)⁽¹⁾ who died in A. M. 1033⁽²⁾ (A. D. 1317).

The Saïdic text which is printed in the following pages has been collated with the Bohairic and the variant readings are recorded in the notes. My best thanks are due to my friend, Dr. Burmester, for his kind suggestions.

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⁽¹⁾ Cf. كتاب التاجيد pp. 257-258.

⁽²⁾ Cf. MS. No. 41(b) *Lit. of the Coptic Museum*, fol. before the last (v). For a description of this MS. cf. G. GAY, *Catalogue de mss. ar. chr. conservés au Caire* (= *Studi e Testi* 63), Città del Vaticano, 1934, No. 58.

Tome XIV of the *Pierpont Morgan Collection of Coptic MSS.*

TEXT.

I. ΠΑΝ·ΦΑΝΟΝ ΠΑΠΑ ΙΩΣΑΝΝΗΣ ΠΕΛΠΙΤΙΣΤΗΣ ρ. ̅̅.

(ADAM).

No. ̅̅, p. ̅̅.

(1) ΠΩΛΧΕ ΠΠΧΟΕΙΣ. ΛΥΩΩΠΕ ΩΛΙΩΣΑΝΝΗΣ. ΠΩΠΡΕ ΠΖΛΧΑΡΙΑΣ. ΕΩΩΟΟΠ ΖΠΠΧΛΙΕ. (2) ΧΕΤΩΟΥΠ ΠΓΕΩΚ. ΕΞΠΠΟΡΑΛΛΗΣ. ΠΓΕΛΠΤΙΖΕ ΠΜΗΝΗΩΕ. ΠΠΟΥΜΟΟΥ ΕΥΜΕΤΑΝΟΙΑ. (3) ΛΥΕΛΠΤΙΖΕ ΠΜΟΟΥ. ΛΥΡΜΠΤΡΕ ΠΛΥ. ΧΕΩΠΠΥ ΜΠΠΩΙ. ΠΠΕΠΕΤΧΟΟΡ ΕΡΟΙ.

For the Bohairic text, cf. the first three verses of the Doxology for St. John the Baptist in *The Book of the holy Laudations* (كتاب التاجيد المقدسة) Cairo, 1922, p. 65, and also the Tarih Adam for the Vigil of Epiphany and for the 1st Ode that is recited at Epiphany (cf. كتاب الطروحات والأصاليات الواطس والادام التي تغلى في برموني وعيدى الميلاد والغطاس) p. 99, Cairo, 1920).

II. ΓΕΓΕΛΠΑ ΣΤΕΦΑΝΟΣ ΠΑΡΧΗΔΙΑΚΟΝΟΣ ΛΥΩ ΠΩΟΡΠ ΠΜΑΡΤΥΡΟΣ, p. ̅̅.

VARIANT READINGS IN THE BOHAIRIC TEXT.

I. ΠΩΛΧΕ ΠΠΧΟΕΙΣ] ΟΥΣΑΧΙ ΠΤΕΠΩΤ/ΩΛΙΑ/ΕΩΩΟΟΠ] omitted/ΞΠ
ΕΩΟΑ ΖΙ/ΠΓΕΩΚ] ΜΛΩΕ ΠΑΚ/ΕΞΠ] ΖΙΧΟΠ/ΠΓΕΛΠΤΙΖΕ ΠΜΗΝΗΩΕ/
ΕΚΕ·ΩΩΕ ΠΜΛΥ/ΠΠΟΥΜΟΟΥ ΕΥΜΕΤΑΝΟΙΑ] ΠΟΥΩΕ ΠΜΕΤΑΝΟΙΑ/
ΛΥΕΛΠΤΙΖΕ ΠΜΟΟΥ] ΕΚΩΕ ΠΠΠΠΠ/ΛΥΡΜΠΤΡΕ ΠΛΥ] ΧΡΙΝΕΩΕ
ΠΩΟΥ/ΠΠΠΠ] ΠΠ ΠΠΠΠΠ/ΠΠΠΠΠΠΠΠΠΠ ΠΠΠΠ ΠΠΠΠ ΠΠΠΠ.
13.

THE TRANSLATION ⁽¹⁾.(1) The *Antiphons* for Apa John the Baptist, p. 1.

(Adam).

No. 9, p. 4.

The word ⁽²⁾ of the Lord came to John the son of Zacharias being in the wilderness ⁽³⁾, saying: "Rise and go to the Jordan and baptize the multitudes ⁽⁴⁾ with water ⁽⁵⁾ unto repentance." He baptized them ⁽⁶⁾ and witnessed to them ⁽⁷⁾, (saying): "He that cometh after me is mightier than I" ⁽⁸⁾.

For the Bohairic text, cf. *The Book of Laudations* (Cairo, 1922), p. 65.

(2) For Apa Stephanos (St. Stephen) the archdeacon and the first martyr, p. 10.

(Batos).

No. 32, p. 11.

A holy ⁽⁹⁾ martyr of Christ Jesus ⁽¹⁰⁾ is Saint Stephen, the interpretation of whose (name) is 'crown'. After God had revealed to him great mysteries, his face was glorified ⁽¹¹⁾, as the face of an angel ⁽¹²⁾. He saw the heavens open (and) behold, Jesus ⁽¹³⁾ at the right of His Father ⁽¹⁴⁾. He prayed for the salvation of those who stoned him. (Refrain) Remember us to the Lord.

B. = Bohairic text.

⁽¹⁾ Greek words in the Coptic text are printed in italics.

⁽²⁾ B. A word.

⁽³⁾ Cf. *Lk.* III, 2.

⁽⁴⁾ B. Thou shalt baptize there.

⁽⁵⁾ B. with a baptism.

⁽⁶⁾ B. Thou baptizest the multitudes.

⁽⁷⁾ B. witness to them.

⁽⁸⁾ Cf. *Mk.* I, 7.

⁽⁹⁾ B. honoured.

⁽¹⁰⁾ B. Our Lord Jesus Christ.

⁽¹¹⁾ Cf. *Acts*, VI, 15.

⁽¹²⁾ B. shone.

⁽¹³⁾ B. My Lord Jesus.

⁽¹⁴⁾ Cf. *Acts*, VII, 55-56.

Extract from No. 33.

Crying out, saying: "Lord Jesus, receive my spirit. Reckon ⁽¹⁾ not unto them this sin ⁽²⁾, for Thou art a merciful God." (Refrain). Remember us to the Lord.

For the Bohairic text, cf. C. LABIB, *The holy Psalms for the whole year* (Cairo, 1908), p. 359.

(3) For Apa Mèna the martyr and all the martyrs, p. 28.

No. 89, p. 32.

For ⁽³⁾ if a man gain the whole world and suffer the loss of his soul, what is this empty gain? ⁽⁴⁾. The holy martyrs ⁽⁵⁾ obeyed the voice of their God ⁽⁶⁾; they forsook the world ⁽⁷⁾ and its perishable glory and delivered up their souls ⁽⁸⁾ to death, and they delivered their bodies ⁽⁹⁾ to fire. They received ⁽¹⁰⁾ great tortures for the sake of the Son of God ⁽¹¹⁾. Wherefore, our Saviour received them into His kingdom, and He gave them ⁽¹²⁾ those good things which eye hath not seen.

Cf. C. LABIB, *op. cit.*, p. 366.

(4) For the patriarch Severus, p. 95.

No. 248, p. 95.

A. Thou hast received the grace of Moses and the priesthood of Aaron. Thou hast received the honour of Peter ⁽¹³⁾, the prince of the Apostles. Christ raised His right hand upon thy head. He entrusted to thee the keys of the kingdom of the heavens in order (p. 96), that thou shouldst be a director over the Churches ⁽¹⁴⁾ to guide ⁽¹⁵⁾ thy people into righteousness and peace ⁽¹⁶⁾.

⁽¹⁾ B. Reckon not my sin unto these men.

⁽²⁾ Cf. *Acts*, VII, 60.

⁽³⁾ B. omits.

⁽⁴⁾ B. life. Cf. *Mk.* VIII, 36.

⁽⁵⁾ B. Saint Apa Mèna.

⁽⁶⁾ B. the divine voice.

⁽⁷⁾ B. he forsook the whole world.

⁽⁸⁾ B. he delivered up his soul.

⁽⁹⁾ B. his body.

⁽¹⁰⁾ B. he received.

⁽¹¹⁾ B. the Living God.

⁽¹²⁾ B. He gave him.

⁽¹³⁾ B. of our father Peter.

⁽¹⁴⁾ B. the Church.

⁽¹⁵⁾ B. to feed.

⁽¹⁶⁾ B. purity and truth.

Cf. C. LABIB, *op. cit.*, p. 399.

No. 250, p. 96.

B. The honoured⁽¹⁾ guide the good fighter, the victor in the contests⁽²⁾, the lamp that lighteneth, the herald of Orthodoxy is Severus the blessed⁽³⁾, the teacher of the reasonable flock of Christ. Thy holy dogmas combat the heretics⁽⁴⁾ as a two-edged sword (lit. two-faced) through the power of the Holy Trinity. Every knee hath adored God⁽⁵⁾; every tongue hath blessed Him. The glory of God hath spread forth and hath filled the face of the universe, for blessed is the Father, the Son and the Holy Spirit, the Perfect Trinity in one Godhead.

Cf. C. LABIB, *op. cit.*, p. 400.

(5) For the Forty Days (Lent). No. 264, p. 101.

A. Fasting and prayer are themselves a redemption of our sins⁽⁶⁾. Purity and peace⁽⁷⁾ themselves cause us to behold God⁽⁸⁾. It was fasting which took Moses up into the mountain to receive the Law for us (p. 102) from God⁽⁹⁾. It was fasting which bare Elias up to heaven and saved Daniel from the den of the lions. Our Lord Jesus Christ fasted for us⁽¹⁰⁾, in order that He might teach us the way by which we may be saved⁽¹¹⁾.

Cf. C. LABIB, *op. cit.*, p. 529.

No. 265, p. 102.

Fasting and prayer are themselves the holy and ready weapons with

⁽¹⁾ B. The sure.

⁽²⁾ B. wars.

⁽³⁾ B. the patriarch.

⁽⁴⁾ B. Thine orthodox dogmas combat the heart of the heretics.

⁽⁵⁾ B. Every knee hath bowed to the Lord.

⁽⁶⁾ B. our souls.

⁽⁷⁾ B. truth.

⁽⁸⁾ B. themselves (things) which are wont to please God.

⁽⁹⁾ B. from the Lord God.

⁽¹⁰⁾ B. adds: forty days and forty nights.

⁽¹¹⁾ B. He might redeem us from our sins.

which Christians (can) fight⁽¹⁾. Daniel fasted and closed mouth of the lions. They were not able to devour him, because he was found fasting⁽²⁾. Our Lord Jesus Christ charged us, saying. Prayer and fasting themselves are wont to cast out the demons. Let us also pray on this wise, saying, "Our Father Who art in heaven, Hallowed be Thy name. Thy kingdom come. For Thine is the glory for ever⁽³⁾."

Cf. C. LABIB, *op. cit.*, pp. 536, 538, 539.

(6) For the Resurrection of our Saviour and His Cross, p. 111.

No. 305, p. 114.

A. He who nourished Israel forty years in the wilderness, gave to them manna (and) they ate it⁽⁴⁾, the bread of angels. In place of manna they gave bitter vinegar to His mouth⁽⁵⁾; in place of good things they set a crown of thorns upon His head. They mocked Him (and) led Him to the place of the Skull, the place in which they crucified Him (and) they crucified also two thieves with Him. They pierced Him (and) they placed Him⁽⁶⁾ in a sepulchre which was outside their city⁽⁷⁾. They said in their ignorance: "This one shall not rise again". On the first (day) of the week Jesus rose⁽⁸⁾ from the dead, (and) ascended to heaven and sat at the right of His Father⁽⁹⁾.

Cf. C. LABIB, *op. cit.*, p. 558.

⁽¹⁾ B. are themselves the weapons of victory, by means of which Christians (may) travel.

⁽²⁾ B. They did not touch his body on account of prayer and fasting.

⁽³⁾ B. glory and honour.

⁽⁴⁾ B. to eat.

⁽⁵⁾ B. to Him.

⁽⁶⁾ B. They prepared Him for burial.

⁽⁷⁾ B. the city.

⁽⁸⁾ B. Early on the first (day) of the week Christ rose.

⁽⁹⁾ ascended Father]. In place of this B. has: He turned His enemies backwards and He gave them eternal opprobrium.

No. 319, p. 117.

B. Then our mouth filled with joy and our tongue with exultation ⁽¹⁾, because our Lord *Jesus* ⁽²⁾ rose from the dead. He brought Death to nought by His power (and) He caused Life to enlighten us. He also Who descended into the depths of the earth ⁽³⁾, brake the *gates* of bronze, He burst the *bolts* of iron. He brought forth His saints in glory and honour ⁽⁴⁾ (and) took them up with Him ⁽⁵⁾ to His resting-places. He saved them for His name's sake (and) He manifested His power ⁽⁶⁾.

Verse which is found in Nos. 308, 310, p. 115 and No. 311, p. 116. Wherefore, we are become rich in *good* and perfect *things*. In *faith* we sing, saying: "Alleluia."

Cf. C. LABIB, *op. cit.*, p. 556.

(7) For Mark the *Evangelist*. No. 354, p. 126.

Mark the *Apostle* and the *Evangelist*, the witness of the suffering of the *Only-begotten* of the Father ⁽⁷⁾. Thou hast enlightened ⁽⁸⁾ us through thy *gospel*. Thou hast informed us of the Father, the Son and the Holy *Spirit*. Thou hast brought us forth from the darkness ⁽⁹⁾, while yet we were sitting under the shadow of death ⁽¹⁰⁾. Thou hast given ⁽¹¹⁾ us the bread of the life which came forth from heaven.

Cf. C. LABIB, *op. cit.*, p. 356.

(8) For the fathers, the holy *Apostles*, p. 135.

No. 388, p. 136.

The first among the *Apostles* was called Peter ⁽¹²⁾, for it was he to whom

⁽¹⁾ Ps. cxi, 3.

⁽²⁾ B. adds: Christ.

⁽³⁾ B. He also went to the places beneath the earth.

⁽⁴⁾ B. His elect in joy and exultation.

⁽⁵⁾ B. He bare them on high with Him.

⁽⁶⁾ B. adds: to them.

⁽⁷⁾ B. of God.

⁽⁸⁾ B. Thou didst come (and) enlightened.

⁽⁹⁾ B. from the darkness to the true light.

⁽¹⁰⁾ while death] B. omits.

⁽¹¹⁾ B. fed.

⁽¹²⁾ B. Simon Peter.

were entrusted the foundations of the *Church* ⁽¹⁾. Another one also, namely, John whom He (*Jesus*) loved exceedingly ⁽²⁾. He leaned upon the breast of *Jesus* ⁽³⁾. The rest of the *Disciples* have the single honour, namely, the *apostleship*, (for) they walked with our *Saviour* ⁽⁴⁾.

Cf. C. LABIB, *op. cit.*, p. 353.

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⁽¹⁾ B. the keys of the kingdom of the heavens.

⁽²⁾ B. He loveth him much.

⁽³⁾ B. our Saviour.

⁽⁴⁾ B. have honour on account of their *apostleship*, because they followed our *Saviour*.